

The New Pixel on the Block

Exactly a year after the original's launch, the Pixel 2 and Pixel 2 XL were first announced on October 4th, 2017. And Google seems much prepared to handle the mass preordering craze this time around (At least we hope it is). The Pixel 2 will ship around the 20th of October while the Pixel 2 XL has a staggered launch and will only ship around 15th of November. The Pixel 2 and the Pixel 2 XL are not mere iterative releases however – the XL

in particular is a whole different beast, even when compared to the Pixel 2.



Not quite edge to edge

The Pixel 2, when physically compared to the Pixel hasn't changed much. In a world where all the flagships are trying to cut down bezels as much as possible (except *cough* iPhone 8/8+ *cough*), the Pixel unfortunately, still has quite the chunky forehead and chin. The screen is 5 inch FHD AMOLED with a 16:9 aspect ratio unfortunately, pretty much the same specs as last year's. Those ergonomic curves and edges characterized in the original Pixel seem a bit angular and sharp this time around, the glass accent on the back is now smaller and doesn't cover the fingerprint sensor and a little bafflingly, the front face is now black no matter what color you choose. (Blue is yet again exclusive, to Verizon). And the power button is a different colour this time around on some colour variants, a move that actually looks really good in person, but nothing unique – to be honest, the Nextbit Robin did it first ;)

The Pixel 2 XL on the other hand, looks drastically different from its predecessor, at least from the front. The same back changes – shortened glass accent (but the only colour choice is black for the accent – creates a nice contrasting dual tone on the white version). But on the front, oh boy. It's not fully bezeless a-la Xiaomi Mi Mix 2 or the Samsung Galaxy S8/S8+ but it's close enough with tiny bezels surrounding a 6 inch pOLED screen with a resolution of 2880x1440. And that's an aspect ratio of 18:9! Yay!

A lot of people who bought Pixels last year were perhaps motivated by the impressive DxOMark score – and other manufacturers took note. Some of the flagships this year made sure to tout their own impressive scores,